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Lily Plant Indoors

This easy-care houseplant is popular with first-time houseplant owners—it can even grow in water alone.

By [Viveka Neveln](#) | Updated on April 9, 2026

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Bob Stefko.

Peace lilies are hugely popular houseplants that are super easy to grow. They feature glossy, emerald-green leaves that [grow in very low light](#). In fact, the peace lily plant's ability to grow in offices and light-deprived homes has earned it the nickname “the closet plant.” However, when placed in bright, indirect light, peace lilies can produce elegant white flowers (a.k.a. spathes) almost year-round. This guide covers

Peace Lily

GENUS NAME	Spathiphyllum
COMMON NAME	Peace Lily
ADDITIONAL COMMON NAMES	Spathe Lily, White Sails
PLANT TYPE	Houseplant
LIGHT	Part Sun, Shade
HEIGHT	1 to 3 feet
WIDTH	1 to 6 feet
FLOWER COLOR	Green, White
FOLIAGE COLOR	Blue/Green
SEASON FEATURES	Fall Bloom, Reblooming, Spring Bloom, Summer Bloom, Winter Bloom
SPECIAL FEATURES	Good for Containers, Low Maintenance
PROPAGATION	Division

Where to Grow Peace Lily

In the wild, peace lilies are tropical plants that thrive on the forest floor, so they love humid environments and dappled sunlight.

Humid Spaces

Rooms with higher humidity, such as bathrooms with a solar tube or skylight, or those near a north- or east-facing window, provide ideal conditions. Avoid placing your peace lily in direct sunlight because the [harsh rays can burn the plant's leaves](#). If light options are limited in your home, a peace lily can still thrive in low-light conditions but it might not produce the pretty flower-like bracts.

Avoid Drafts

It is also best to avoid placing your peace lily near heat sources or drafts. Temperature fluctuations caused by fans, vents, air conditioners, open doors, fireplaces, radiators, and space heaters can [cause the foliage to droop](#) and wilt.

Sheltered Outdoors

Outdoors, peace lilies are only [hardy in Zones 10–12](#). If you live in a warmer climate, you can plant mature, divided, or seedling peace lilies

WARNING

The leaves and flowers of peace lilies are considered toxic to humans. ^[1] They are also toxic to cats and dogs. ^[2] Keep these plants away from pets and small children.

How and When to Plant Peace Lily

To plant a peace lily outside, dig a hole twice the size of the plant's root ball. Place the plant in the hole, fill it with soil, and water thoroughly. Peace lilies can also thrive in containers outdoors within tropical climates.

When growing a peace lily indoors, you can plant at any time, but spring is ideal for planting or repotting. Use a container slightly larger than the plant's root ball, and fill it two-thirds full with well-draining, peat-free houseplant potting soil or compost. Position your peace lily in the pot and stabilize it as you fill the remainder with soil. Water thoroughly.

TIP

Experiment with growing peace lilies in distilled, purified, or rainwater alone. Use a vessel or insert that suspends the plant above the waterline for an innovative display.

Care Tips for Peace Lily Plant

Caring for a peace lily is straightforward, making it a perfect choice for novice plant owners. Follow these guidelines to maintain your peace lily's health and beauty.

Light

Whether indoors or outdoors, peace lilies thrive in [bright, indirect light](#). While they can survive in low-light conditions, they may produce fewer spathe flowers with less compact growth.

TIP

To keep the glossy green leaves looking their best, occasionally wipe them with a damp cloth to remove dust.

Soil and Water

Peace lilies require a nutrient-rich, well-draining potting mix, ideally with a pH of 5.8 to 6.5, to prevent [root rot](#) from excessive moisture.

Temperature and Humidity

Peace lilies flourish in warm, humid environments with temperatures between 65° and 80°F and humidity levels of 50% or higher. Avoid exposing the plant to temperatures below 40°F. To increase humidity, use a nearby humidifier.

RELATED: [The Best Humidifier for Plants, Tested by BHG](#)

Fertilizer

Occasionally apply a slow-release fertilizer, but avoid over-fertilizing. Limit applications to every six weeks during spring and summer. If leaves are [yellowing or browning](#), reduce the fertilizer. For peace lilies grown in water, supplement with liquid fertilizer every four to six weeks to compensate for the absence of soil nutrients.

RELATED: [The 9 Best Fertilizers for Indoor Plants, Reviewed by BHG](#)

Pruning

Regular pruning and deadheading are beneficial (at least every six months). Once a stalk has bloomed, it won't rebloom and should be cut back at the plant's base to make way for fresh growth. Remove yellow or withered leaves and spathe flowers with pruning shears.

Potting and Repotting

Peace lilies prefer slightly tight pots, so repot only when roots protrude from the drainage holes. When [repotting your peace lily](#), remove as much old soil as possible and choose a pot only slightly larger in diameter.

Pests and Problems

Peace lilies don't have many issues with pests, but those attracted to moist microclimates can be problematic. If you see evidence of [mealybugs](#), [fungus gnats](#), [thrips](#), [scale](#), and [spider mites](#), it's best to address them quickly. Allow the soil of your peace lily to dry out a little more between waterings and use an insecticidal soap or [neem oil to eradicate the pests](#).

Root rot is another common issue for peace lilies—especially when they are overwatered. It causes [yellowing and wilting in the lower foliage](#) as well as brown spots on the leaves and (depending on the type of rot) also on the stalks.

Leaf blight is another issue that is exacerbated by high humidity levels and moist soil conditions. It can create brown or black lesions on the leaves that appear wet and mushy. If you catch it early, you can curtail the disease by removing the affected leaves and repotting the plant in fresh soil and a sterilized pot.

RELATED: [The 7 Best Potting Soils Keep Your Plants Happy and Healthy](#)

How to Propagate Peace Lily

The simplest way to propagate peace lilies is via division. Spring is the best time to do this, but if your plant is becoming overly pot-bound, any time will do. Each time you divide a plant, you will need to wait until it has reached maturity and is large enough to separate into multiple sections.

To divide your peace lily plant, gently remove the plant from its pot and pry apart the stems into 2 or 3 clumps (making sure each clump has its own set of roots). Replant each of the new divisions in a separate container as you would a new plant.

Types of Peace Lily

Peace lilies come in different sizes, and a few offer variegated leaves. Here are a few examples.

Wallis Peace Lily



Credit: Denny Schrock

The most common type of peace lily is *Spathiphyllum wallisii*, which features large glossy, green leaves and white, calla-like blooms. It can reach up to 3 feet tall indoors.

'Domino' Peace Lily

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Credit: Blaine Moats

This variety of *Spathiphyllum wallisii* is a form with variegated foliage. It also blooms, but its main attraction is its green foliage speckled with cream and white.

'Jetty' Peace Lily

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Credit: Denny Schrock

'Jetty' is a fast-growing, lush variety of *Spathiphyllum* with loads of white spathe flowers.

'Mauna Loa' Peace Lily



Credit: Marty Baldwin

'Mauna Loa' is a vigorous variety of *Spathiphyllum wallisii* that grows to 3 feet tall with pure white blooms.

'Sensation' Peace Lily



Credit: Denny Schrock

This variety of *Spathiphyllum wallisii* is a giant among peace lilies, growing up to 6 feet tall, with proportionately large flower bracts.

Frequently Asked Questions

Why are my peace lily flowers turning green?

We call them flowers, but the blooms on peace lilies are technically spathes. The large, white spathe of the peace lily is a modified leaf (called a bract). It protects the spadix, which is the spike of small flowers held upright in the center of the spathe. As these flowers age, the spathe fades to green. However, since the peace lily has little need for fertilizer, the bracts can also turn green when overfed.

Is a peace lily related to true lilies?

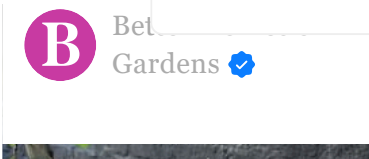
Native to the tropical regions of South America, the peace lily is not [actually a true lily](#). It's a member of the Araceae family—which includes other houseplant favorites like [pothos](#), [philodendron](#), and [monstera](#).

Do peace lilies purify the air?

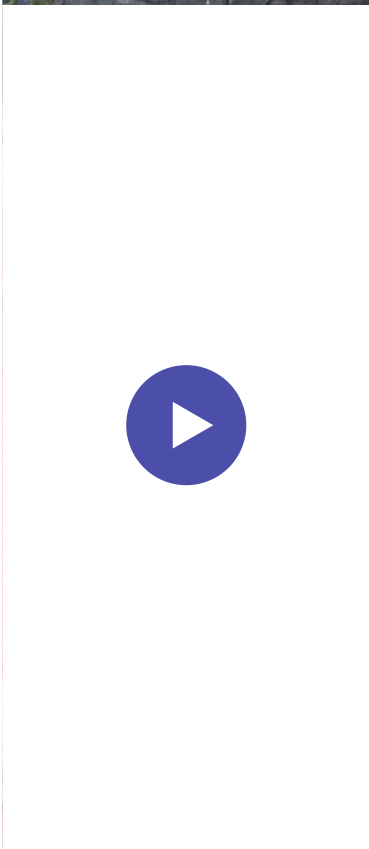
Yes and no. The National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) did a study in the late 1980s ^[3] that indicated that certain plants (like the peace lily) could absorb environmental contaminants such as carbon monoxide and formaldehyde from indoor air. However, that study was conducted in conditions that mimic a sealed spacecraft, not a home. Also, later studies ^[4] have shown that you would need as many as 10 plants per square foot

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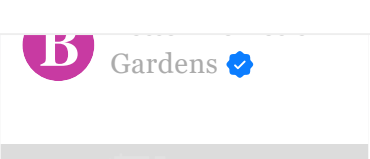
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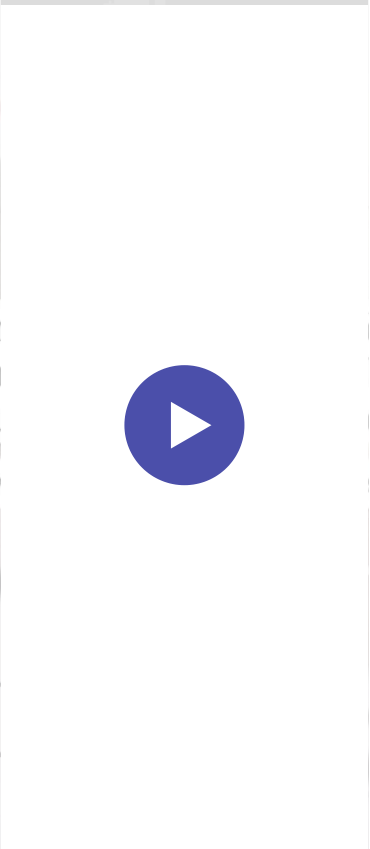
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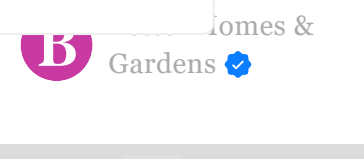
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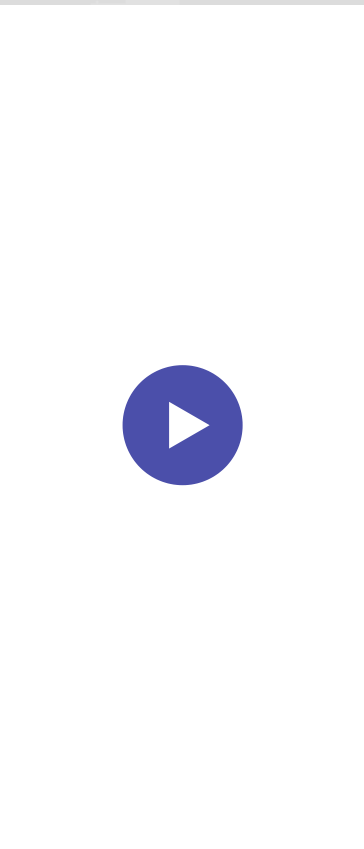
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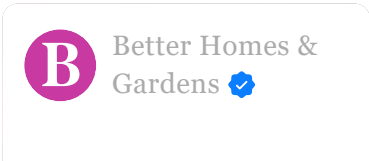
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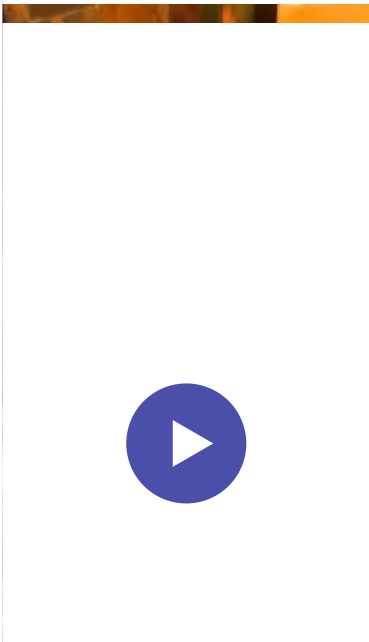
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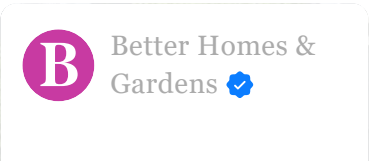


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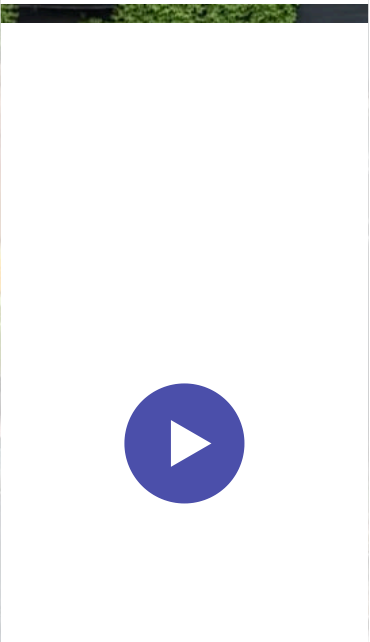


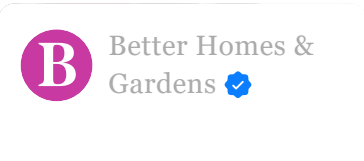
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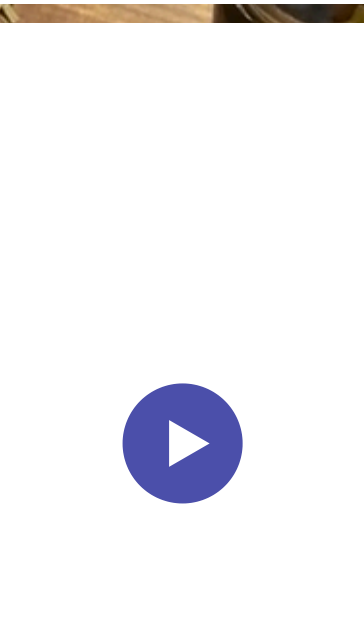


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